FINANCE PLANNING
mortgage & protection

July 2026

CONTINUAL PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Welcome to the latest edition of the FPG monthly round-up newsletter covering everything you need to know including recent industry updates, risk news, mortgage and protection updates and some performance figures.

England march on at the World Cup and interest rates continue to slowly fall, let's hope both continue!

FPG are on hand for anything you need so please get in touch with anything we can help with.

Thank you.

David

risknews

Compliance News 09/26 – New ASU provider – Allianz
Allianz have replaced Wessex, and you can now recommend AS, ASU or U cover from Allianz. The product is still underwritten by AmTrust in the background. You should have all (with a protection licence) received an email inviting you to register for the Allianz portal.

Compliance News 10/26 – ERC mandatory annual testing (Equity Release Advisers only)
Lifetime Mortgage Advisers are required to complete the mandatory Equity Release Council test, and also the AiR Academy distance learning.

Compliance News 11/26 – Consolidating debt to an Interest Only mortgage
Due to the potential for poor customer outcomes on Interest Only cases with Debt Consolidation (where the debt might be remaining outstanding for many years without being reduced) we will no longer allow this advice/business. However, we might agree to such a case, by exception, but you will first need to gain approval from the compliance team.

Record Keeping
We have recently provided updated suggested paragraphs which you can use for your mortgage and your protection Suitability Reports in Acre.

Introducers
All Introducers must be approved by the compliance team. Where you receive any introduced business, please ensure that you are recording the source of the introduction/lead on Acre. Where your Introducer isn't included in the drop-down options, please inform David Riley so this can be added for you.

LBG Spotlight on Fraud
Attached to this email is a flyer from Lloyds Banking Group. Please can you all familiarise (refresher read) yourselves with its contents. In particular, you are reminded to be submitting lender applications which are a true representation of the applicant's situation. Anything

other than this is considered to be misrepresentation (mortgage fraud). Some examples of such misrepresentations are:

1. Adding an applicant's bonus to their salary instead of including it in the separate box for bonus (same applies to overtime income)
2. Stating your applicant is employed when their PAYE income is actually from a contract with a fixed term
3. Under-stating their number of dependents

These are just some examples. But in each of these scenarios, it could result in a lender increasing it's lending to an applicant beyond the figure that they would otherwise wish to lend – and a lender will regard this as mortgage fraud.

More on Financial Crime

CIFAS has recently published two of its annual reports around fraud trends in the UK. The first of these is Fraudscape which provides high level industry trends in fraud types. One particular type of fraud on the rise is 'account takeover' where cybercriminals gain unauthorised access to a legitimate user's online account and steal the funds. They can gain access by either purchasing stolen credentials on the dark web, or by phishing.

The second of the fraud reports is Fraud Behaviours which captures changes in the public's perception of fraud and financial crime. The key findings from this second report include:

- 21% of respondents view money-muling as reasonable. This is where you knowingly allow your bank accounts to wash dirty money, for a financial reward.
- 24% of respondents did not recognise lying on a mortgage application was illegal, with another 7% actually thinking it was legal to do so.
- Approximately 50% of respondents believe that first party fraud was reasonable. Some examples of this fraud type are non-delivery fraud, council tax fraud or mobile phone insurance fraud.

This is why it is so important that we remain vigilant when examining a client's paperwork, and always be challenging the plausibility of things like how they do a second job, or how they accumulated their deposit, or even what can they tell you about their primary (or only) job if it seems a highly paid job for their age or experience. Even existing clients might be over-playing their income when looking to borrow more money.

HSBC – Fraud prevention webinars

HSBC have a couple of fraud prevention refresher sessions planned in the next couple of months. 19th August at 10am and 7th September at 2pm. If you wish to attend these please refer to your HSBC emails, or ask Pete Burgess.

AMI re-brand

Our trade body, the Association of Mortgage Intermediaries has re-branded itself to:
Advice. Mortgages. Insurance.

FCA – Proposals to replace LISA

The FCA is proposing to replace the Lifetime ISA with a new savings plan to help first time buyers save for their deposit. Full of imagination, they are looking at calling it the First Time Buyer ISA (FTB ISA).

FCA – Crypto to be regulated

Historically there was no regulation around crypto-assets. More recently though, the FCA has been focussing on anti-money laundering controls and financial promotions. But from October 2027, firms carrying out crypto-asset activities will need to be regulated by the FCA, in the same way that we are today for mortgages and protection advice. The new regulatory regime will cover the full lifecycle of crypto-asset activities, including trading custody, safeguarding, staking and redemption (with specific provisions for stablecoins*). Now you probably need a stable coin explanation!* Well, we are definitely not crypto clued-up, so it will be best if you can let your preferred AI app give you its view – but essentially, stablecoins are a form of digital cash, whereas the likes of Bitcoin is (I think) just made up nonsense! But a nonsense nonetheless from which many people have got very rich, and some have made serious losses!

FCA – CP 26/18 Mortgage Rule Review (MRR)

The FCA are currently going 'consultation' crazy, and their latest papers are all about supporting first time buyers, underserved consumers, and those borrowers in later life. This is because FCA have been clear that the mortgage market has evolved and consumer needs have changed, prompting a necessary review of the rules to support these cohorts of borrowers. These recent papers are not new standalone news, but more something that sits within a much larger regulatory roadmap that stretches from last year's Mortgage Market Rule Review (CP 25/11 for anyone who likes to recite these consultation papers). **This is what the FCA are proposing:**

- **Interest only and part and part mortgages –** a more proportionate, tiered approach to repayment strategies, with flexibility for borrowers at lower LTVs and recognising that future transitions (such as into RIOs) can form part of a credible repayment strategy/plan.
- **Retirement interest only (RIO) –** the FCA want RIOs to become more accessible and a natural follow-on option for borrowers approaching the end of an interest-only term, encouraging lenders to take a more realistic view of later-life income. Removing the single income stress test affordability requirement is a major shift, but it also heightens the importance of protection conversations and long-term planning.
- **Variable and irregular income –** expanded guidance on assessing affordability for varied and irregular income and clarification that repayment schedules at other frequencies besides monthly payments should be considered.
- **Credit impaired borrowers –** a shift away from strict definitions towards a holistic, current-state assessment that recognises recovery, stability and context. This is because the current approach, which is very much 'baggage based', may exclude too many otherwise suitable borrowers.
- **Foreign currency lending –** a controlled loosening of overly restrictive rules to better serve global workers.
- **Bridging loans –** clearer expectations on exit strategies and affordability, reflecting how bridging is now used by mainstream consumers. The FCA is also proposing to update the handbook definition of regulated bridging loans so that they can run for up to 24 months, rather than the current 12-month limit.

These are permissive changes, meaning lenders will have discretion over whether to adopt them. As the landscape changes, we feel that "advice" remains central to assist clients with their borrowing needs. The consultation on these rule changes closes on 28th July 2026. If you have strong views, please speak to Pete or Dan asap.

There is a further **FCA consultation paper CP26/22** entitled **simplifying the insurance rules**, but we do not see how this affects us as its aim is to provide further distinction between advised and non-advised sales. All our protection sales are already fully advised, hence this not impacting our processes.

CPD reminder

Just a reminder that as we are now, somehow, in the second half of the year, you should all now have at least 8 hours of mortgage CPD recorded on your CPD Logs, plus at least 8 hours of insurance CPD too. And where you hold an additional licence for Lifetime Mortgages, PMI or Business Protection then you should be recording CPD in these licence areas too.

protectionnews

One of our advisers, Colin Mackay, had been discussing life cover with a client for over six months. The client had recently started his own limited company, had a £300,000 mortgage, a wife and two children, but despite regular conversations about the importance of protection, he just couldn't commit to putting cover in place. Then, shortly after receiving our new Protection Brochure, Colin emailed it across with a simple message: *"Received this today. Immediately thought of you. Can we take time to sort this for you?"* The response was immediate. The client got back in touch straight away and an application for £1 million of Life Cover with Legal & General was submitted. It's a great example of how the right conversation, supported by the right tools, can help clients take action to protect what matters most.

🔹 Guardian – Launches CIC Essentials

Guardian has launched CIC Essentials, a new critical illness proposition designed to provide high-quality cover at a lower cost. Cover focuses on the conditions most commonly claimed for, helping advisers protect more clients who may have previously been priced out of comprehensive critical illness cover. It's a welcome addition to Guardian's already well-regarded protection range.

👉 https://adviser.guardian1821.co.uk/

🔹 Vitality – Pays Record £149m in Protection Claims

VitalityLife has published its 2025 claims statistics, revealing it paid a record £149 million in protection claims during the year. This included £105m in life cover claims, with 99.4% of life claims paid, alongside £42m in Serious Illness Cover claims. The figures highlight the real-world value of protection and provide powerful evidence of the support available when clients need it most.

👉 https://adviser.vitality.co.uk/life-insurance/doing-business/claims/

🔹 Royal London – Record Protection Payouts in 2025

Royal London has announced record protection payouts of £821 million, supporting more than 62,000 customers and families during 2025. The mutual paid 98.4% of all protection

claims, reinforcing the importance of protection advice and the value of cover when life's unexpected events occur.
👉 https://adviser.royallondon.com/protection/our-claims-record/

New Guardian CIC Essentials policy

Whilst this is a very good core CIC product, it is not as good as the better CIC products. As such, our preferred CIC provider is still Guardian, but it is their enhanced CIC product (which you've always been recommending) which is our preferred CIC product – still. When you are quoting for your recommended solution, please ensure you select their CIC product and not their CIC Essentials product. Essentials is the inferior product which they have just released to compete with the core/standard/basic products from the likes of L&G and Zurich.

mortgagenews

The main theme of the month was lots of re-pricing from several different lenders with very few specific criteria updates.

Clydesdale

This lender has been retired by Nationwide Building Society. Whilst pipeline cases are being honoured, they are now closed to new business. *(We wouldn't be surprised if Virgin falls victim too, perhaps in the next year or two – although this has not been announced at all!).*

Halifax and BMS brands to fall too

And in a recent announcement, Lloyds Banking Group also intend to retire the Halifax and BMS brands, with everything being consolidated under the Lloyds brand, from sometime in 2027.

In the shorter term however Halifax have confirmed that we now have access to Lloyds Loyalty Premier products, these are discounted mortgage deals for customers who hold a Lloyds Premier current account. That is in effect now with Halifax rather than when everything moves across to the Lloyds brand.

Halifax and BMS system and mortgage ERCs

Please note that there is a discrepancy with the Halifax and BMS systems, as highlighted below. Where a client is eligible to switch to a new product with Halifax or BMS, their system now highlights that there are no ERCs. This is true for a PT, but not true for a re-mortgage to a new lender. In the example below, an ERC will apply until 30th Sept, despite the system showing no ERCs. *Just beware – the issue has been reported!*

Sub-account 01

Balance	Monthly payment	Remaining term	Repayment type
£101,295	**£646.87**	**14 years 6 months**	**Repayment**
Product description	Rate	Product code	Early repayment charges
Fixed until 30/09/26	**1.49%**	**FBM900**	**£0.00**

The Leeds and the MSO system

A refresher of the correct procedure to follow when recommending a PT with the Leeds. You should be aware that there is a message on the MSO system to signpost the Adviser to fully submit a rate switch application after the offer is issued. Leeds have now enhanced the warning in an email that will go to the broker once they produce an offer within the system *(The red highlight is for the benefit of this communication, it isn't on the email to the broker)*

Notification of Mortgage Offer for Case Number: S20772794 Mr RYDER

Dear Sir Dahana Agrawal,

We're contacting you to confirm we've issued an offer to Mr RYDER.

This offer is valid until 14 December 2026 and is now available within the case documents by logging in using the link below:

Log in

If this application is for a rate switch, please make sure you've clicked 'Submit switch' to submit the application in full. Your client's new rate will only be secured when you submit your application.

Kind regards,

Mortgage Lending Department

After the offer is produced, you must continue to process the case in MSO to actually submit the PT to secure the offer – the creation of the offer itself has not achieved this.

Metro Bank

Metro have launched a new Greater than 95% LTV JBSP mortgage. This expands their current proposition, the main details are

- Available up to 100% LTV
- No minimum deposit/equity requirement
- Residential Purchase or £4£ Remortgage
- 5-year fixed rate products
- No valuation or product fee
- Income can be accepted from up to 4 applicants, at 4.45x income multiple, subject to affordability
- Maximum loan size of £675,000
- Joint Borrower must be immediate family only

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for June 2026

Congratulations to **Dan Fletcher** for topping our mortgage table for last month.

Adviser	Cases
Dan Fletcher	**29**
Jonathan Peachey	27
Rob Chart	25
Paul Gent	24
Claire Lipscomb	22
Hannah Logan-Hughes	19
Phil Smith	19
Tim Dock	18
Emily Chattaway	18
Paul Ripley	17
Carl Thorne	16
Scott Sutton	15
Dipes Rai	15
Joanne Pope	15
Jack Savory	14
Oscar Delves	13
Andy Poustie	13
Matt Stephens	12
Bryce Protheroe	12
Catherine Rafferty	12
Graham Morris	11
Alex Strange	11
Petru Balan	10
Asmita Gurung	10
Ellis Featherbe	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for June 2026

Congratulations to **Paul Gent** for topping the protection table for last month.

Adviser	Cases
Paul Gent	**64**
Rob Chart	55
Clare Mann	32
Arbin Gurung	27
Andy Poustie	22
Ben Burgess	12
Petru Balan	12
Hannah Logan-Hughes	11
Ellis Featherbe	11
Jane Hutchinson	10

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables.

millionaireclub

Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases so far.

Mortgage cases

Oliver Cunningham	£2,025,000
Hannah Logan-Hughes	£1,977,095
Paul Goodey	£1,564,486
Jim Maye	£1,560,101
Hannah Logan-Hughes	£1,400,000
Paul Goodey	£1,370,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,300,000
Oliver Cunningham	£1,275,646
Paul Goodey	£1,210,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,196,680
Wilma Scott	£1,158,035
Jim Maye	£1,153,379
Cathy Rafferty	£1,135,868
Tracey Copeland	£1,123,000
Paul Goodey	£1,117,500
Cathy Rafferty	£1,112,151
Tony Hornby	£1,105,899
Paul Goodey	£1,099,999
Jonathan Peachey	£1,085,950
Paul Goodey	£1,066,449
Karen Mills	£1,025,000

Phil Smith	£1,015,000
Rob Chart	£1,007,671

Protection cases

Simon Harris	£1,800,000
Paul Gent	£1,500,000

If you have submitted a policy of £1m or over, or a group of policies to the same client which add up to over £1m, please let me know.

goodnews

FPG Anniversaries

A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Rob Chart – 25 years
- Maria Crawley – 22 years
- Tina Wisdom – 21 years
- Michelle Barlow – 15 years
- John Steer – 13 years
- Gary Bray – 3 years
- Manita Gurung – 2 years

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list, if you should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in July.

- Adam Hayward
- Amit Swar
- Andrew Drake
- Arbin Gurung
- Carl Thorne
- Dan Fletcher
- Ellis Featherbe
- Emma Langford
- Gary Bray
- James Burberry
- Kudzai Manjengwa
- Maria Crawley
- Phil Smith

- Richard Hamley
- Richard Lucy
- Victoria Wescott

miscellaneous

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status. We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable, please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

Past Zoom sessions

Here are the details of the Zoom sessions FPG hosted last month and the links to re-watch them. All the below are good for CPD.

02/06/26 – Allianz ASU Launch - https://knowledgehub.website/2-06-2026-allianz-asu-launch/

08/06/26 – Digital & Kensington - https://knowledgehub.website/8-06-2026-digital-and-kensington/

15/06/26 – Leeds & NatWest - https://knowledgehub.website/15-06-2026-leeds-and-natwest/

22/06/26 – Guardian & Scottish Building Society - https://knowledgehub.website/22-06-2026-guardian-scottish-building-society/

29/06/216 – Skipton - https://knowledgehub.website/29-06-2026-skipton/

Future Zoom sessions

And these are the session that are already booked in over the next month, would be great to see as many people as possible at them. Each session is on a Monday afternoon at 4pm, invites are emailed out approx. 15 mins before the session begins. If you are not receiving the email invites please inform your Sales Manager who can resolve that for you.

06/07/26 – Exeter & Pete Burgess
13/07/26 – Allianz & Tipton
20/07/26 – Co-op/Coventry & Newcastle